Benham Haynes

Systems Administrator | Cybersecurity | Incident Response

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CEH (EC-Council) · CompTIA Security+ · C)DFE (Certified Digital Forensics Examiner)

SUMMARY

Systems administrator at a managed service provider supporting multiple client environments across Microsoft 365, Entra ID, Intune, firewalls, and wireless networks. Hands-on incident response experience with Huntress, ESET, and Barracuda, from account lockdown through investigation and client reporting. Holds CEH, Security+, and C)DFE, is completing a Network Administration degree Summa Cum Laude (4.0 GPA), and leads nationally ranked cyber competition teams. Brings 10+ years of client-facing and operations management experience to technical work where communication matters.

EXPERIENCE

Systems Administrator — GripD dba Get IT Right Solutions (MSP) Apr 2026 – Present

- Respond to security incidents using Huntress, ESET, and Barracuda: lock down compromised accounts, investigate scope, and deliver incident reports to clients.
- Administer Microsoft 365, Entra ID, Intune, Exchange Online, and Google Workspace across client tenants, including user lifecycle, dynamic distribution groups, and Copilot policies.
- Built a new-user onboarding automation app with Power Apps and Power Automate to standardize account provisioning.
- Designed and deployed a guest WiFi captive portal on IronWifi and Ruckus Cloud with SMS sign-in; traced a sign-in failure to a Ruckus MAC/IP encryption setting conflicting with IronWifi.
- Configure and manage SonicWall and Fortinet (FortiGate, FortiCloud) firewalls, Ruckus and MikroTik access points, and IPv6 hardening on client networks.
- Integrated a customer phonebook into GoTo Connect and built a GoTo wallboard TV display for live call queue visibility.
- Ran Gophish phishing simulation campaigns for client security awareness training.
- Provide end-user and remote support through NinjaRMM, Tactical RMM, and RepairShopr; track assets in Snipe-IT and manage credentials in Keeper.
- Manage Apple Business Manager and Verizon Business accounts for client device fleets.

Assistant and IT Support — RM Volpe & Associates 2008 – 2011, 2017 – 2020

- Supported a small office network, workstations, plotters, and peripherals.
- Handled scheduling, client communications, invoicing, and check processing.

Hairstylist — Vogue Salon Sep 2021 – Dec 2025

- Built and retained a personal client base through consultation and consistent service in a fast-paced salon.

National Retail Compliance Coordinator — SmartCircle 2015 – 2017

- Audited retail locations nationwide against company and regulatory standards and delivered training to close compliance gaps.

Assistant Manager — Popeyes 2011 – 2015

- Ran daily operations, trained staff, and handled cash and inventory control.

PROJECTS

Proxmox Security Lab (Dell T7910, PowerEdge R520)

- Segmented attack network on its own bridge with Parrot OS and Metasploitable targets for penetration testing and Active Directory exploitation practice.
- SonicWall TZ500 gateway, UniFi AP, AdGuard Home DNS filtering, and a WireGuard VPN gateway in LXC containers, Tailscale for remote access.

ShadowApple (Saddleback Cyber Builders and Breakers Group)

- DIY WiFi Pineapple on a GL-AR300M router running OpenWrt and PineAP, built for club wireless security demos. Full build log and defensive hardening write-up at xpop3.github.io.

COMPETITIONS AND LEADERSHIP

- Team Lead, CIRCUS Incident Response Competition: 2nd place 2025 and 2026 (2026 event sponsored by Anthropic).
- Team Lead, SoCal Cyber Cup: 8th of 540.
- Team Lead, NCAE CyberGames: 5th of 16.
- Competitor, WRCCDC; active on HackTheBox and TryHackMe.
- Leader, Saddleback Cyber Builders and Breakers Group (SCBBG); Class Liaison, Saddleback CS Department.

EDUCATION

A.S. Network Administration — Saddleback College 2024 – Oct 2026

GPA 4.0, Summa Cum Laude · Certificate of Achievement, Security Analysis

Cosmetology — Toni & Guy Academy 2019 – 2020

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH), EC-Council
- CompTIA Security+
- Certified Digital Forensics Examiner (C)DFE)

SKILLS

Security & IR	Huntress, ESET, Barracuda, Wazuh, Velociraptor, Volatility 3, Autopsy, FTK Imager, Metasploit, Nmap, Burp Suite, Wireshark, Impacket, Gophish
Identity & Cloud	Microsoft 365, Entra ID, Intune, Exchange Online, Active Directory, Google Workspace, Apple Business Manager, Power Apps, Power Automate
Networking	SonicWall, FortiGate, FortiCloud, Ruckus Cloud, MikroTik, UniFi, IronWifi, VLANs, WireGuard, Tailscale
RMM & Tools	NinjaRMM, Tactical RMM, RepairShopr, Snipe-IT, Keeper, GoTo Connect
Systems	Windows Server 2022, Proxmox, Hyper-V, Kali, Parrot OS, Ubuntu, Rocky Linux, Debian
Scripting	Python, Bash